

intended node, would be retransmitted. Concepts that were developed at ALOHAnet, like the need to reduced data collision among data packets, were used for the same effect in the case of the Ethernet protocol.

1971

The Microprocessor Arrives

July: The beginnings of Project Gutenberg

Michael Hart, a University of Illinois student, gained infinite computing time on the University Mainframe computers. Specifically, on the Xerox Sigma V mainframe at the Materials Research Lab of the University, he gained computing time that had an estimated value of \$100 million then (Rs 3,700 crore today). This meant he could use the Sigma V for an unlimited period for his research purposes. He wanted to gift back something of value to the community, so he started Project Gutenberg. He set a goal of making electronically available the 10,000 most-consulted books and copyright-free public domain works. The first text Michael Hart made electronically available was the United States Declaration of Independence.

October: The first e-mail program

Ray Tomlinson, then 30, found a way to send text over a network while working on a project called SNDMSG. We now call this e-mail. Tomlinson, along with a team working on the TENEX operating system, wrote the first basic e-mail programs SNDMSG and READMAIL.

Many believe that Tomlinson was the inventor of e-mail, but in point of fact, he invented the software that allowed messages

Where You @?

Ray Tomlinson, then employed with BBN (Bolt Beranek and Newman), which used Tenexa as the operating system, sent the first e-mail using the “@” symbol, creating a meaningful address: “user@host”. His own e-mail address was Tomlinson@bbn-tenexa.